

THE BIRTHDAY ISSUE · 25

Mira Vale

Twenty-five, with clay under her
fingernails

MIRA VALE, AN INSTINCT FOR MAKING ROOM

THE TINY BOAT COMMITTEE MEETS IN THESE
PAGES

BIRTHDAY ISSUE
2001-08-14

OPENING NOTE

A note from your sister

Mira, this issue gathers the small things you do that stay with people: a shelf in order, a detail remembered, a quieter voice invited in. I am proud to be your sister, and I hope your care finds its way back to you.

Why this issue exists



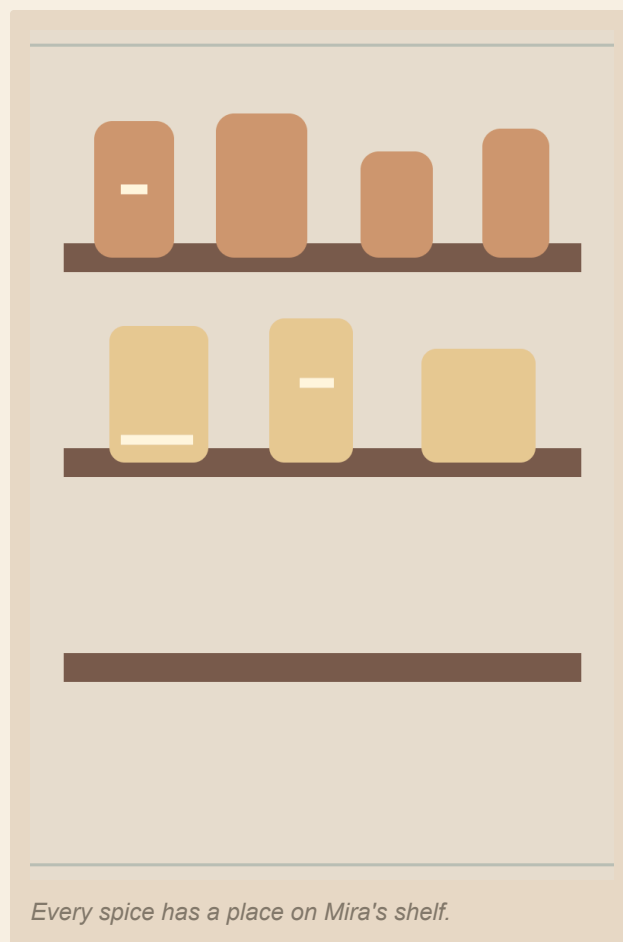
Slow mornings are on the birthday wish list.

WHO THEY ARE

The care tucked into small details

Mira alphabetizes the spice shelf and remembers tiny details people mention once. At a table, she notices who has not found their way into the conversation yet.

The details that stay



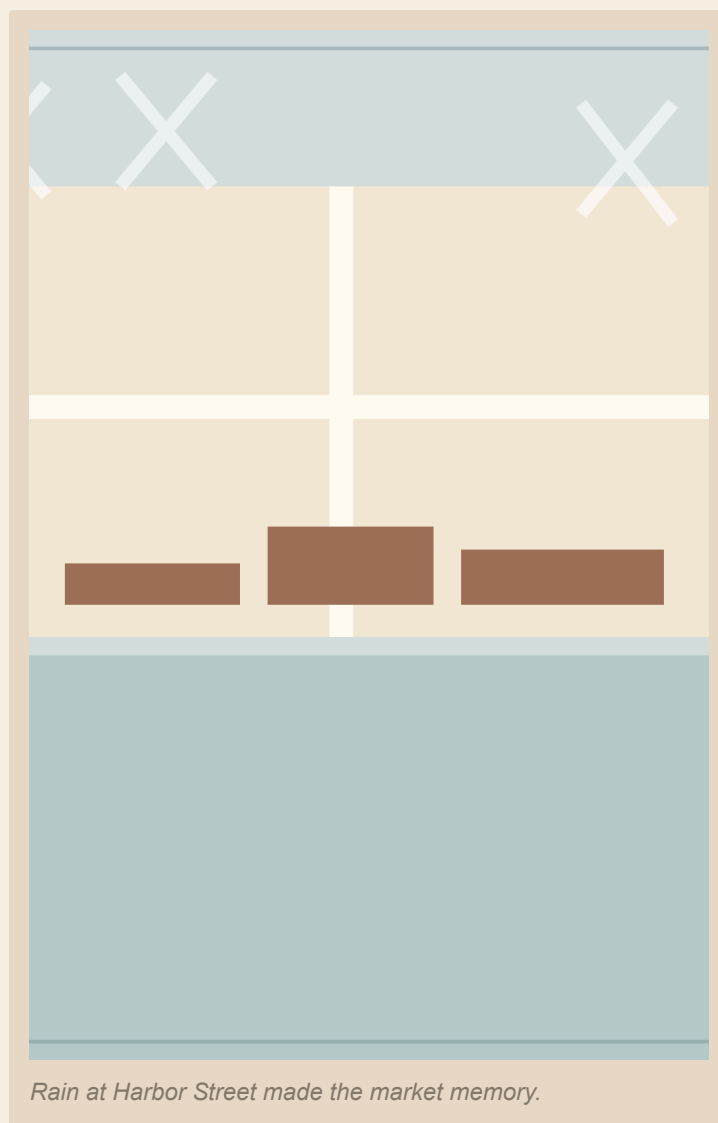
Every spice has a place on Mira's shelf.

FEATURE MEMORY · 01

A Saturday that turned paper into boats

Rain met the Harbor Street book market on a Saturday. When the lights flickered, you carried the paper bags to a window seat at Dot Cafe, split a cinnamon roll, and waited for the rain to clear.

Harbor Street, in the rain

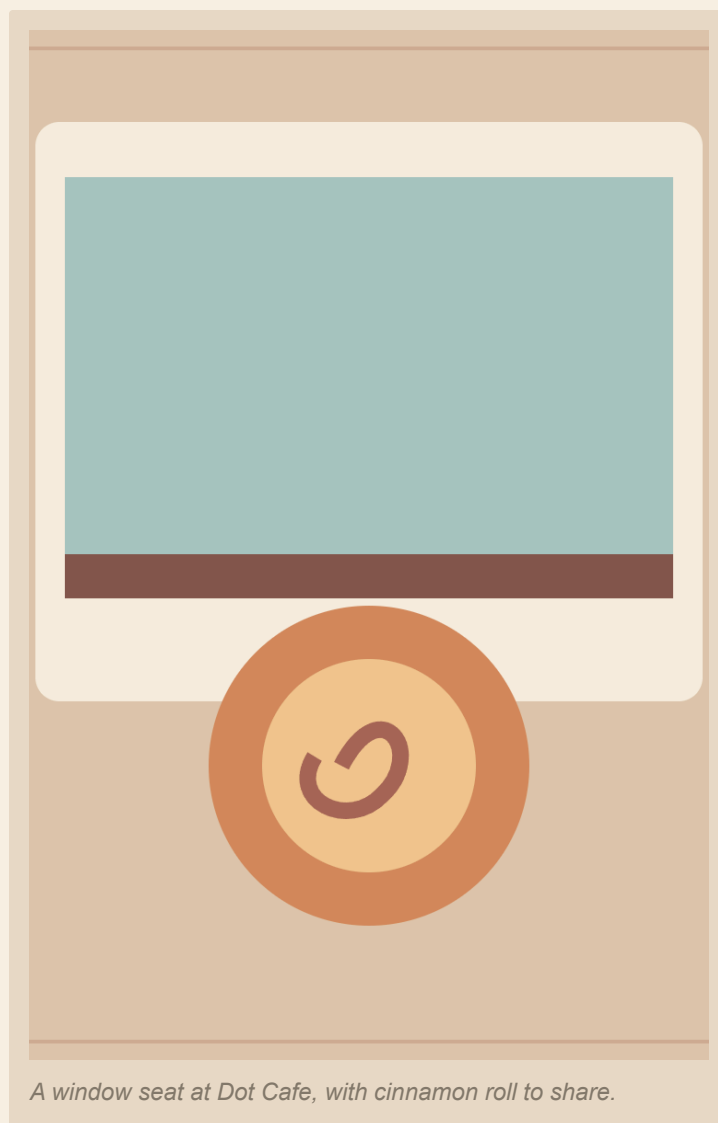


FEATURE MEMORY · 02

The scene we kept

Mira folded the empty receipt into tiny boats while you waited. The memory now has a name between you: the tiny boat committee.

A receipt became a boat



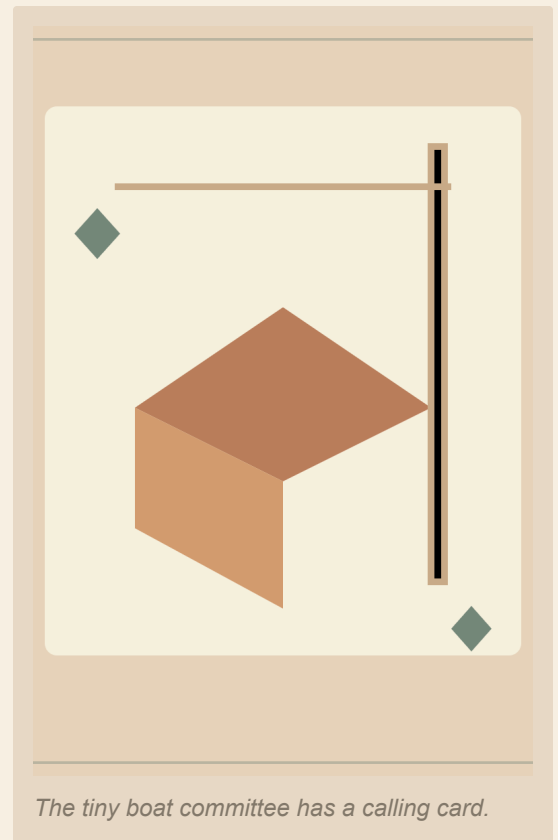
A window seat at Dot Cafe, with cinnamon roll to share.

THE LORE / INSIDE JOKES

Rules for a small boat committee

An empty receipt becomes tiny boats; Saturday begins with the first pancake belonging to its cook, even when it is lopsided. These are your two ordinary-morning rules, and together they can rescue almost any ordinary morning.

A small tradition takes shape



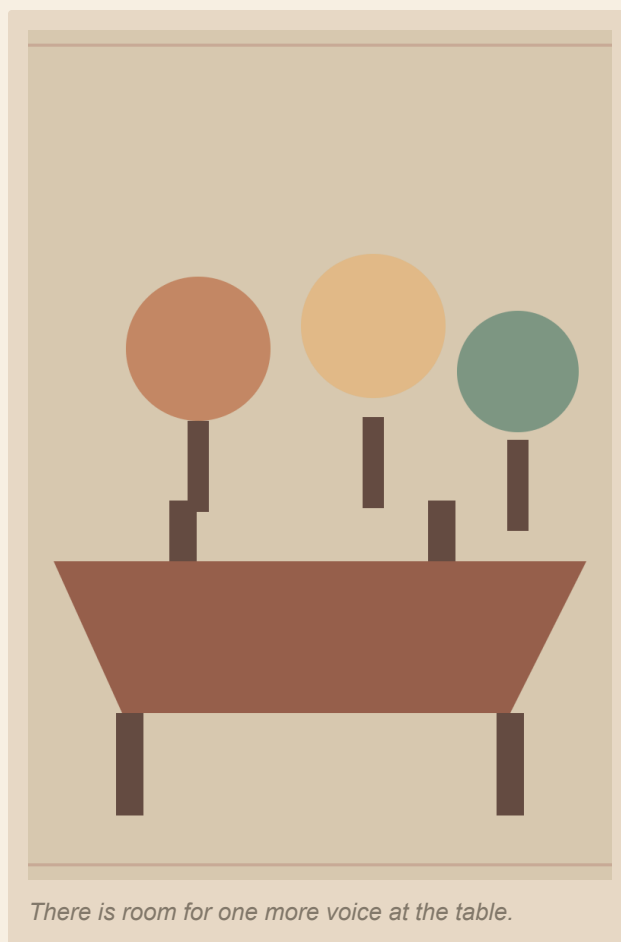
The tiny boat committee has a calling card.

WHY THEY MATTER

Care with follow-through

Mira makes room in practical ways: she asks the quieter person a real question, remembers the answer, and calls when she says she will. Her kindness is steady enough that people can lean on it; this is care with follow-through.

The kind of kindness that remembers



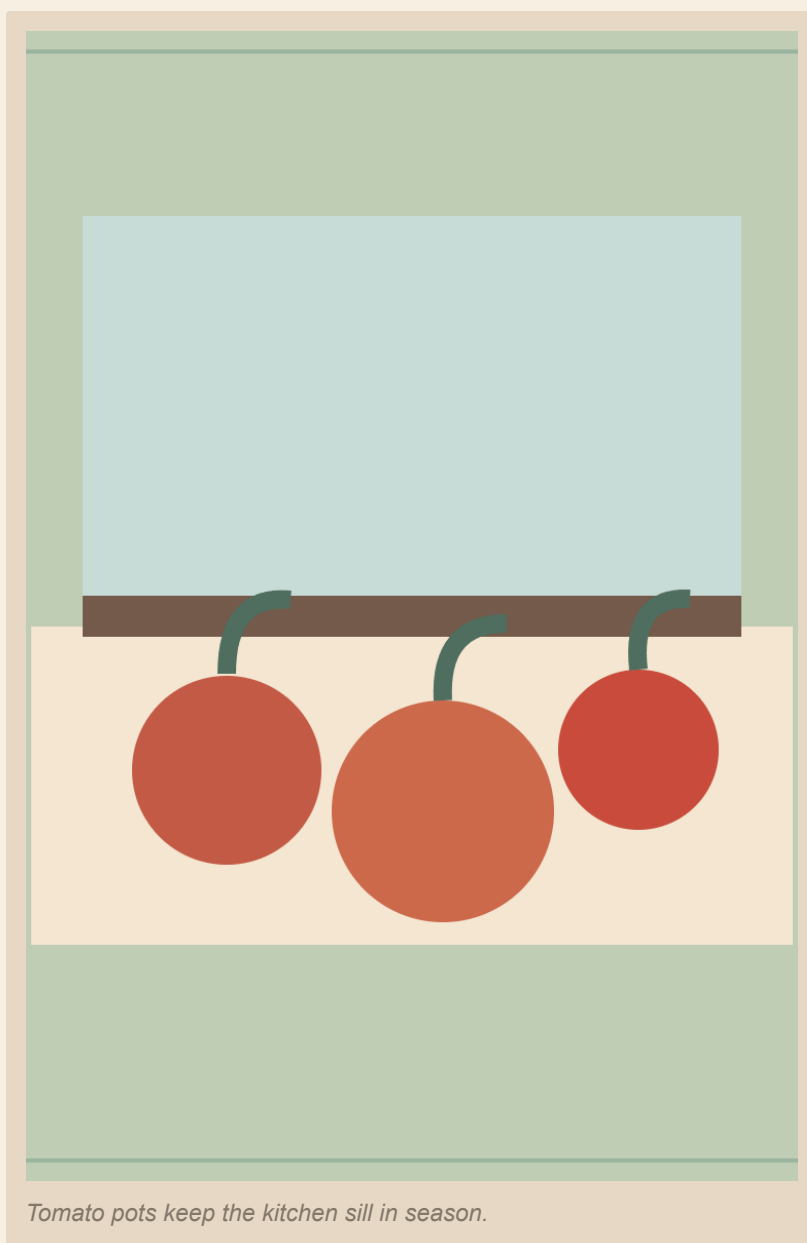
There is room for one more voice at the table.

PHOTO STORY · CURRENT ERA

A present tense made of Wednesdays and walks

Mira goes to ceramics at Farrow Studio every Wednesday. Tomato pots sit on the kitchen-window sill.

A life in the making



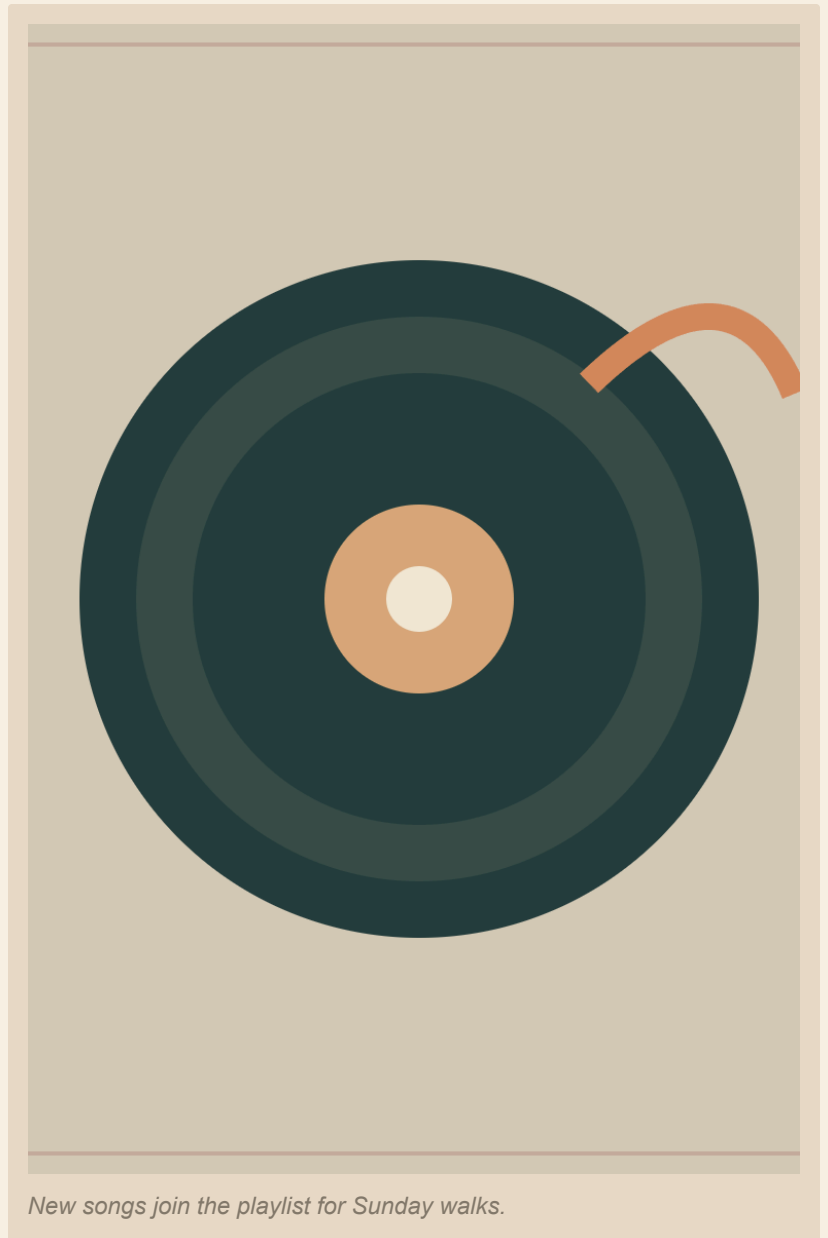
Tomato pots keep the kitchen sill in season.

PHOTO STORY · CURRENT ERA

The week, in small rituals

She keeps adding songs to the playlist she takes on Sunday walks. At the North Loop farmers market, she likes the flowers and the slow start to the weekend.

Room to grow at its own pace



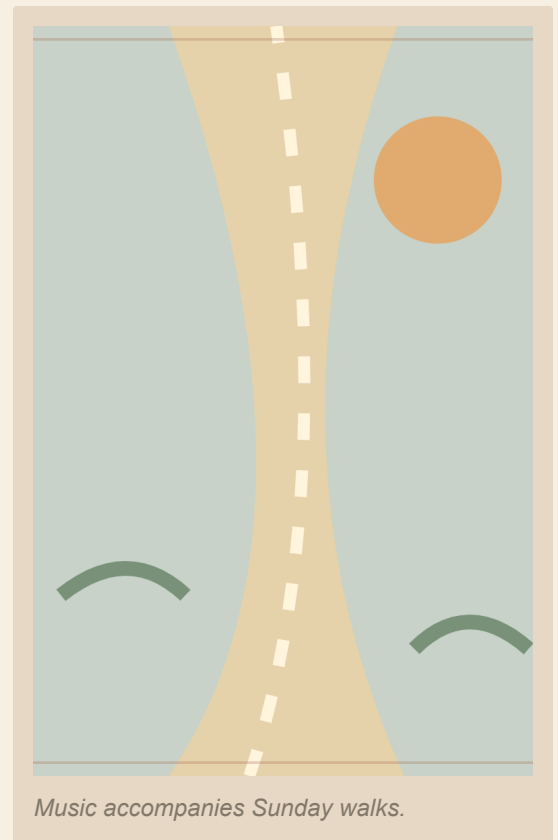
New songs join the playlist for Sunday walks.

CURRENT OBSESSIONS

The week, in clay and green

Wednesday ceramics at Farrow Studio, tomato pots on the kitchen-window sill, and new songs for Sunday walks make up Mira's current rhythm. The North Loop farmers market is for flowers and a slow weekend start.

Clay · tomatoes · Sunday walks



BIRTHDAY LETTER · NEXT CHAPTER

May your care come back around

For this birthday, I hope the care you give everyone else finds its way back to you. May 25 bring slow mornings, music for every walk, clay under your fingernails, and room around the table. I am proud to be your sister. I love the life we keep making in small pieces.

For 25, and what comes next

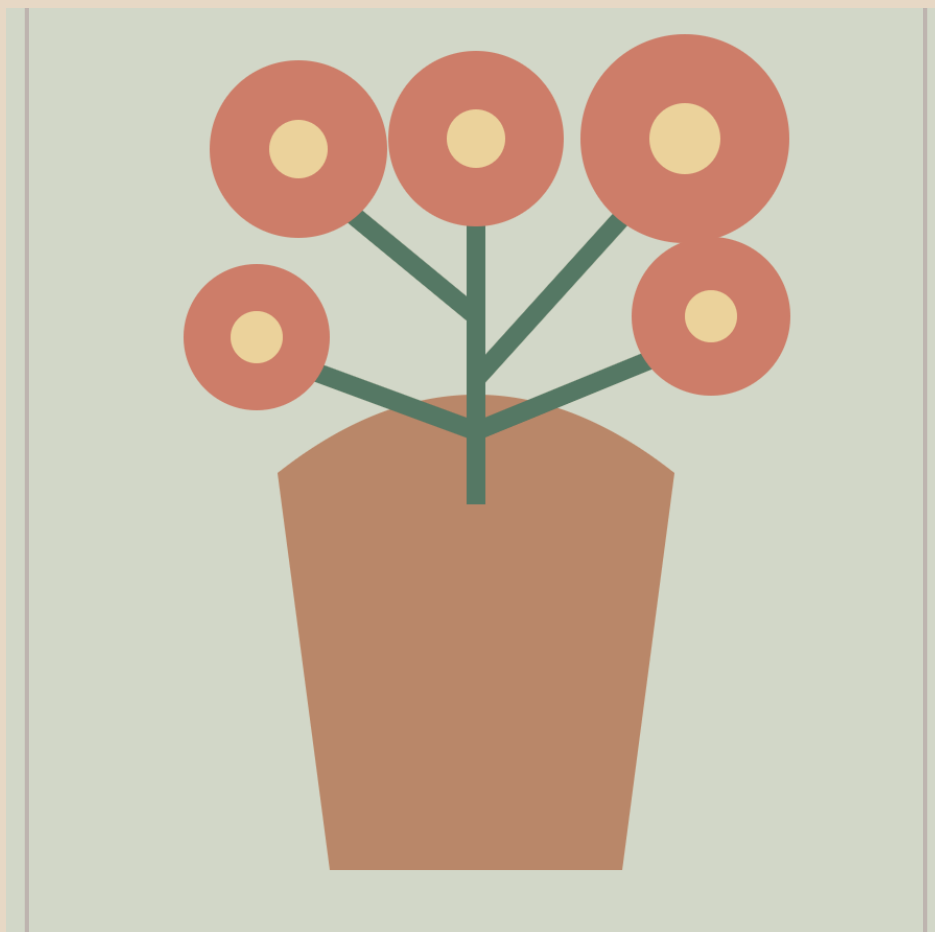


BACK COVER

Mira Vale

Keep making a life in small pieces.

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North Loop flowers and a slower weekend start.